

Akhil's Interview Readiness OS (June 20 - July 31, 2026)

Goal: Become interview-ready for ServiceNow, Salesforce, T-Mobile, Walmart, JPMorgan, Microsoft, Adobe, Optum and similar companies while continuing full-time work at GAP.

Core Principles

1. No random learning.
2. Every topic must satisfy one of: Interview Topic, Current Work Topic, or AI Differentiator.
3. Track outputs, not hours.
4. Every day: one DSA problem + one engineering note.

Career-OS Repository Structure

career-os/
01-DSA
02-Java
03-Spring
04-Kafka
05-Kubernetes
06-React
07-AI
08-SystemDesign
09-Behavioral
10-Applications

Daily Formula (Weekdays)

Session 1 (30–45 mins): DSA using NeetCode 150 only.
Track: Problem, Pattern, Time, Mistakes, Revision Needed.

Session 2 (45 mins): Deep Engineering Topic.
Create one note with: What, Why, How, Architecture, Failure Modes, Interview Questions, How We Use It At GAP.

Weekly Rotation

Monday: Java (HashMap, ConcurrentHashMap, ExecutorService, CompletableFuture)
Tuesday: Kafka (Partitions, Consumer Groups, ISR, Rebalancing)
Wednesday: Spring (Bean Lifecycle, AOP, @Transactional, Security)
Thursday: React (Hooks, Redux Toolkit, Rendering, State Management)
Friday: AI (LLMs, MCP, RAG, Agents)
Saturday: System Design
Sunday: Interview Simulation

Learning Sources

DSA: NeetCode 150
Java: Baeldung + Java Brains

Spring: Baeldung + Spring Docs
Kafka: Confluent Developer + Gwen Shapira
Kubernetes: TechWorld with Nana + KodeKloud
React: React.dev + GAP codebase
AI: MCP Docs + Spring AI Docs + LangChain Concepts
System Design: ByteByteGo + Alex Xu

AI Track

Week 1: LLM Fundamentals
Week 2: MCP Concepts and Architecture
Week 3: RAG (Embeddings, Chunking, Vector DBs)
Week 4: Agents (Planning, Memory, Tool Usage)

Build at least one small MCP-related project and document it.

System Design Goals

1. API Gateway (CDP Migration story)
2. Product Catalog (Product Foundation)
3. Notification System (Kafka)
4. CI/CD Platform (GitHub Actions + Chartis)
5. Developer Productivity Agent (AI + MCP)

Behavioral Stories

1. CDP Migration
2. AKS Optimization
3. Kafka Migration
4. Sonar + MCP Automation
5. 503 Probe Analysis

Success Criteria by July 31

40–50 curated DSA problems solved.
30–40 engineering notes created.
5 system design documents.
5 polished behavioral stories.
1 MCP project.
20–30 targeted applications submitted.